

PERFECT FIT WITHOUT STARTING OVER™ • BONUS 1

40 Fit Problems and How to Fix Them

What you see at the fitting, why it happens and what to change in the pattern.

Contents

Corset · top edge and bust	1
Corset · waist and hip	2
Corset · back and lacing	3
Bras and bralettes	4
Bodysuits and knickers	5
All garments	6

How to use this guide

When something doesn't fit, look up what you see at the fitting. Each problem comes with its most common cause and what to change in the pattern.

- 1** Always fit with a toile before cutting the good fabric.
- 2** Mark what's excess or missing on the toile with pins and chalk.
- 3** Correct the pattern, not just the toile: that way it comes out right next time.
- 4** One correction at a time, in this order: length, circumference, shape.

If you're unsure between two causes

Start with the simpler one (length or circumference) and fit again. If you're still stuck, tell the AI Assistant what you see.

Corset • top edge and bust

1. The neckline gapes away from the body

What you see: There's air between the top edge and the chest

Likely cause: The pattern's bust measurement is bigger than the client's, or the top edge is too high

Correction: Pinch out the excess on the toile and mark it; remove that amount spread across the front and side seams, only at the bust line, and smooth the curve down towards the waist.

2. It squeezes and pushes the bust up (“overflow”)

What you see: The bust spills over the top edge

Likely cause: Not enough bust measurement, or the pattern's cups are too small for her bust

Correction: Open the seams of the bust panels and add what's missing, spread across the front panels; if the neckline is too low for her bust, raise the top edge.

3. A horizontal wrinkle under the bust

What you see: A fold from side to side under the bust

Likely cause: The front waist length is longer than the client's, or the underbust is too big

Correction: Mark how much is excess on the toile and shorten the pattern at the underbust line, or take in the underbust on the front seams.

4. The cups are loose or hollow

What you see: The fabric doesn't sit on the bust

Likely cause: Cup projection bigger than the client's bust

Correction: Reduce the curve of the bust seam (take volume out at the peak of the curve) and try again; don't reduce the circumference.

5. The top edge digs into the armpits

What you see: Uncomfortable when lowering the arms

Likely cause: The side is too high

Correction: Lower the top edge at the side gradually, 1–2 cm ($\frac{3}{8}$ – $\frac{3}{4}$ in), and re-blend the curve with the front and back.

6. It looks flat and doesn't shape the bust

What you see: The front sits straight

Likely cause: The pattern has a straight silhouette, or the client has a fuller bust than the base pattern

Correction: Add curve to the bust panel seams, or choose a pattern with more projection.

7. The busk bends or lifts at the top

What you see: The front fastening doesn't sit straight

Likely cause: Too much tension at the bust, or the busk is longer than the straight part of the body

Correction: Check the bust measurement; if it persists, choose a shorter busk or a curved one.

8. Bra straps show or it doesn't work with her underwear

What you see: It doesn't go with what she wears underneath

Likely cause: The fitting was done without the underwear she'll actually wear

Correction: Repeat the fitting with her final underwear, or add straps to the corset.

Corset • waist and hip

9. A wrinkle at the side of the waist

What you see: Diagonal folds at waist level

Likely cause: The pattern's waistline doesn't match her real waist

Correction: Mark her real waist on the toile with a ribbon and raise or lower the pattern's waistline on every panel.

10. It's too tight at the waist

What you see: It hurts or leaves marks

Likely cause: More waist reduction than the client is comfortable with

Correction: Add to the waist, spread across all the seams; a corset made for comfortable wear doesn't need a big reduction.

11. It digs into the hips when sitting

What you see: Uncomfortable when seated

Likely cause: The length below the waist is longer than her seated waist-to-thigh distance

Correction: Shorten the front and side bottom edge, or give it more upward curve at the front.

12. It gapes at the hip

What you see: There's air at the hip

Likely cause: The pattern's hip measurement is bigger than hers

Correction: Remove the excess on the side and back seams, only at the hip, keeping the waist.

13. It squeezes the hips and rides up

What you see: The corset climbs when she moves

Likely cause: Not enough hip measurement, so the body pushes it upwards

Correction: Add to the hip, spread across the side and back seams.

14. It twists to one side

What you see: The seams run diagonally

Likely cause: Panels cut off grain, or an asymmetric body

Correction: Check the grain of each piece; if the body is asymmetric, adjust only the side that needs it.

15. The bones show through or come out of the channel

What you see: You can see the tip of the bone

Likely cause: Bones longer than the channel, or an unfinished channel

Correction: Cut the bone 1 cm ($\frac{3}{8}$ in) shorter than the channel and tip the ends; close the channel properly before binding.

16. It wrinkles between the bones

What you see: Ripples in the outer fabric

Likely cause: Outer fabric without a firm layer, or badly joined to the coutil

Correction: Flatline the outer fabric to the coutil (or interface it) before assembling the panels.

Corset • back and lacing

17. The back doesn't close evenly (wider at the top or bottom)

What you see: The lacing gap is V-shaped

Likely cause: Where the gap is widest, the corset is missing measurement for that body

Correction: Where it opens too much, it's missing circumference: if it opens more at the bottom, add at the hip (side and back seams); if it opens more at the top, add at the bust or upper back. The sum: the extra gap (for example $9 - 4.5 = 4.5$ cm, about $3\frac{1}{2} - 1\frac{3}{4} = 1\frac{3}{4}$ in) $\div 2 =$ what you add to each half of the pattern, spread across its seams. The ideal is an even gap of 4–5 cm ($1\frac{1}{2}$ –2 in).

18. The back closes completely with no gap left

What you see: The two edges meet

Likely cause: The corset is too big

Correction: Take in the side and back seams to leave an even gap of about 5 cm (2 in), so it can be adjusted.

19. A wrinkle in the lower back

What you see: Horizontal folds above the bottom

Likely cause: Back length longer than hers, or a pronounced lumbar curve

Correction: Shorten at the back waistline, or add curve to the back seam.

20. The shoulder blades show or the top digs in

What you see: Uncomfortable when moving the arms

Likely cause: Back top edge too high or too tight

Correction: Lower the back edge by 1–2 cm ($\frac{3}{8}$ – $\frac{3}{4}$ in) or add a little to the upper back.

21. The lacing slips and loosens

What you see: It needs re-tightening often

Likely cause: Slippery lacing, or eyelets too far apart

Correction: Use flat cotton or firm satin lacing and eyelets 2–2.5 cm ($\frac{3}{4}$ –1 in) apart.

22. The eyelets pull out

What you see: The fabric tears around them

Likely cause: Not enough reinforcement or no bone next to the eyelets

Correction: Put a bone on each side of the eyelet line and use firm interfacing.

Bras and bralettes

23. The strap slides off the shoulder

What you see: It slips when she moves

Likely cause: Strap placed too far out for her shoulder

Correction: Move it 1–2 cm ($\frac{3}{8}$ – $\frac{3}{4}$ in) towards the centre at the back and the front.

24. The underwire digs in under the arm

What you see: Uncomfortable at the side

Likely cause: Wire longer or wider than the base of the bust

Correction: Use a wire one size smaller, or a shorter one at the side.

25. The centre doesn't sit on the breastbone

What you see: The gore stands away

Likely cause: Cups too small or wire too narrow

Correction: Make the cup bigger or use a wider wire.

26. The band rides up at the back

What you see: The back climbs

Likely cause: Band too loose; the straps are carrying the weight

Correction: Take in the band; it should sit firm and horizontal.

27. Spillage over the top or side of the cup

What you see: The bust spills out

Likely cause: Cup too small

Correction: Enlarge the cup at the joining seam, or move to the next cup pattern up.

28. Wrinkles in the cup

What you see: Folds in the fabric

Likely cause: Cup too big

Correction: Take volume out of the cup seam, or move to the cup pattern below.

Bodysuits and knickers

29. The bodysuit pulls from shoulder to crotch

What you see: It pulls when she stretches or sits

Likely cause: The pattern's torso length is shorter than hers

Correction: Lengthen the pattern at the waistline: what's missing, half on the front piece and half on the back.

30. The bodysuit bags at the waist

What you see: Excess fabric at the front

Likely cause: Torso length too long

Correction: Shorten at the waistline.

31. The knickers ride up at the back

What you see: They creep in

Likely cause: Not enough fabric at the back for her bottom

Correction: Add coverage to the back piece, especially towards the centre.

32. The knickers dig in at the leg

What you see: The elastic cuts in

Likely cause: Elastic too tight or leg opening too small

Correction: Reduce the tension on the leg elastic or enlarge the opening.

33. The knicker waist drops or rolls

What you see: The elastic folds over

Likely cause: Elastic too loose or not wide enough

Correction: Use firmer or wider elastic and check the tension when sewing it.

34. The crotch pulls at the front or back

What you see: Uncomfortable at the crotch

Likely cause: Rise length uneven for her body

Correction: Lengthen or shorten the gusset piece on the half that pulls.

All garments

35. The toile fitted but the final garment doesn't

What you see: What was right is now wrong

Likely cause: The final fabric stretches differently from the toile fabric

Correction: Make the toile in a fabric that behaves similarly, or interface the final fabric.

36. It fits standing but not sitting

What you see: Uncomfortable when she sits

Likely cause: The fitting was done standing only

Correction: At every fitting, ask her to sit, raise her arms and bend over.

37. The same pattern fits one client and not another

What you see: Every body is different

Likely cause: The pattern is drafted for base measurements

Correction: Always grade the pattern to each client's measurements before cutting the toile.

38. The corrections never end

What you see: Each fitting something new comes up

Likely cause: Several things are being corrected at once, in no order

Correction: Correct in order: length first, then circumference, then shape (cups, curves). One thing at a time.

39. It fits well but she feels uncomfortable

What you see: The garment is “right” but she doesn't want to wear it

Likely cause: A gap between what she expected and what was made

Correction: At the first conversation, ask what she'll wear it for and how fitted she likes it; note it on the form.

40. The fabric distorts after many fittings

What you see: The toile ends up stretched

Likely cause: Too many fittings on the same toile

Correction: After two big corrections, cut a new toile from the corrected pattern.

Next step

At your next fitting, keep this guide open and note on the form which problem came up and what you corrected.